
NEGOTIATION DRAFT — AUTHORIZED NEGOTIATORS ONLY

Framework for Reciprocal Stabilization

Executive Operational Arrangement with Technical Annexes

Version 4.0 — Integrated Triad/Sprint Edition

May 2026

Status: **Step-Back/Earn-Back Negotiator Draft**

Supersedes Version 3.2 (May 2026)

MERGED FROM GSA V1.5 & STEP FORWARD V2.0

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — READ THIS FIRST

For Senior Officials. Read this before the full document.

The Problem

Zero-sum deadlock. Neither side can move first. Washington demands nuclear commitments before sanctions relief. Tehran demands economic benefits before nuclear concessions. Neither can move first without appearing to capitulate. The result: a costly deadlock benefiting no one.

The Solution

Synchronized moves. Both move together. Every Iranian commitment triggers a corresponding US commitment on the same clock cycle. Verification is shared. Benefits are front-loaded from Day One. The arrangement is classified as an **Executive Operational Protocol** — not a treaty, not a binding compact, not a permanent obligation.

The Backbone (MVC): Four Elements That CANNOT Collapse

1. Ceasefire 72-hour auto-renewing; Omani-facilitated hotline	2. Humanitarian Corridor Zero-fee, non-divertible Hormuz transit
3. 60% Enrichment Freeze IAEA verification within 72 hours	4. \$250M Tranche Swiss escrow, non-reversible, UN OCHA authority

The Core Exchange (Day 1)

See the detailed table in **Section 2** (page 8 of this document). The Three Core Swaps replace thirty micro-incentives with three macro-swaps that capture 90% of the value with 10% of the paperwork:

- **Swap 1:** Iran freezes 60% enrichment → US releases \$250M + Bank Melli SWIFT
- **Swap 2:** IRGC-Navy stands down → US lifts naval blockade

- **Swap 3:** Iran exports HEU stockpile to Oman → US issues Boeing aviation waiver

What Each Side Gets

Iran: "We preserved sovereignty, NPT rights, and enrichment. We secured \$250M in immediate humanitarian relief and a pathway to greater relief. We reopened our ports. We moved as equals."

United States: "We removed weapons-grade uranium from Iranian territory. We capped enrichment at 3.67%. We got IAEA inside every facility within 72 hours. We kept all military options. We demonstrated American leadership by going first."

Both claims are factually accurate. Neither undermines the other.

Total pages to read: 4 (this summary + Sections 1-3). The rest is technical annexes. This document is approximately 35 pages. A negotiator can grasp the essentials in 10 minutes.

Source: *Executive Decision Brief adapted from GSA v1.5 (page 4). The Core Triad governance, 30-Day Sprint option, and Direct Co-Arbitration are integrated from GSA v1.5 Sections VIII, IX, and 3.4 respectively. Anti-goalposting and judicial pause provisions are drawn from the Mutual Step-Back Agreement v4.0.*

Contents

Part 0: Executive Summary (Read First)

Part I: Core Political Instrument

1. Nature and Classification
 - 1.14 No Goalpost Moving (New)
2. Core Exchange and Reciprocal Commitments
 - 2.7 30-Day Sprint Option (New)
3. Minimum Viable Configuration (Backbone)
4. Governance and Dispute Resolution
 - 4.1 The Core Triad (Amended)
 - 4.2 Emergency Backchannels
 - 4.2A Direct Co-Arbitration (New)
 - 4.11 Emergency Judicial Pause (Expanded)
5. Withdrawal and Continuity

Part II: Technical Annexes

- Annex A: Nuclear Custody and Verification
 - A.1A Prohibition on US Custody (New)
- Annex B: Maritime Governance (PGSA)
- Annex C: Economic Architecture and Escrow
- Annex D: Cyber Resilience and Anomaly Detection
- Annex E: Escalation, Shock Absorption, and Force Majeure

Appendix: Reference Instruments and Sources

Part I: Core Political Instrument

1. Nature and Classification

1.1 Executive Operational Arrangement

This instrument is classified as a **Synchronized Stabilization Arrangement** and Executive Implementation Mechanism. It is not a treaty, not a binding compact, and not a permanent obligation. It is an operational protocol between governments exercising their respective executive authorities. Implementation occurs only through existing lawful authorities available to each party. Nothing in this arrangement requires either party to violate its domestic constitution, applicable national law, or binding international obligations.

1.2 Presumptive Continuation Subject to Statutory Authorities

All provisions operate on a presumptive continuation basis. Timeline advancement is the default state when telemetry data reports congruent compliance. Stopping requires affirmative evidence-backed action. No provision binds future congresses or parliaments permanently. All obligations are subject to "best efforts" and "good faith implementation" through each party's lawful authorities.

1.3 Severability

If any provision of this arrangement is determined unenforceable by a court of competent jurisdiction or legislative body, all remaining provisions continue operative without modification. No single provision's invalidity affects the enforceability of the arrangement as a whole. Hostile actors cannot attack one clause to destabilize the entire framework.

1.4 No Supersession of Domestic Law

Implementation occurs only through existing lawful authorities. Neither party is required to enact new legislation to activate the arrangement. The PGSA exercises delegated administrative authority, not sovereign authority. It does not supersede UNCLOS, does not create supranational jurisdiction, and does not impair Iran's rights under Article 37. No inference of sovereignty dilution, international trusteeship, or maritime concession may be drawn.

1.5 Non-Precedent Firewall

This arrangement establishes no legal or political precedent for unrelated disputes globally. It is *sui generis*, tailored exclusively to the May 2026 operational environment. No inference may be drawn regarding: non-proliferation in other states; maritime governance in other waterways; sanctions architecture for other jurisdictions; or bilateral diplomatic frameworks with other parties.

1.6 Best Efforts and Good Faith

Politically sensitive provisions — including sanctions relief sequencing, asset return timing, and technology licensing — are subject to "best efforts" and "good faith implementation" rather than absolute obligation. Legislatures, courts, and future executives are not hard-bound. Escrow-preauthorized liquidity transfers replace direct punishment mechanisms: parties voluntarily pre-authorize escrow contingencies at signature, making enforcement a matter of pre-agreed financial architecture rather than post-hoc penalties.

1.7 Supplementary Clarification Memorandums

The parties acknowledge the exchange of synchronized, non-prejudicial Side-Letters of Understanding deposited concurrently with the Joint Coordination Secretariat on Day Zero. These letters define localized public communication parameters and domestic designation tracking, serving as administrative supplements without altering multilateral obligations.

1.8 No Private Right of Action

Nothing in this arrangement confers any private legal right or cause of action upon non-state actors, including corporations, insurers, sanctioned entities, advocacy organizations, or individuals. All rights and obligations are exclusively inter-governmental. No domestic court may enforce any provision of this arrangement at the request of a private party. Disputes between states and private entities regarding framework transactions are governed by existing commercial arbitration frameworks, not by this instrument.

1.9 Sovereign Immunity Preservation

Participation in this arrangement does not constitute waiver of sovereign immunity for either party. All dispute resolution mechanisms apply only to the extent that both parties voluntarily submit to them in accordance with their respective domestic procedures. Escrow operations are conducted through the Swiss Financial Cell as an administrative function of a neutral third party, not as an enforcement action by either state. No inference of sovereign immunity waiver may be drawn from escrow participation, PGSA membership, or any other framework activity.

1.10 Interpretation Hierarchy

In the event of contradiction or ambiguity, provisions shall be interpreted in the following descending order of authority: (1) the Core Political Instrument (Part I); (2) the Technical Annexes (Part II); (3) Side-Letters of Understanding deposited with the Secretariat; (4) written Secretariat guidance issued with concurrence of both parties; (5) custom and practice developed through framework operation. No single provision may be interpreted in isolation so as to defeat the object and purpose of the arrangement as a whole.

1.11 Non-Implied Recognition

Participation in this arrangement does not imply recognition of any unrelated territorial claim, ideological position, security doctrine, or political alignment by either party. Cooperation on nuclear verification, maritime transit, and economic escrow creates no inference regarding positions on regional conflicts, alliance structures, or bilateral relationships with third parties. Each party retains full independence in all unrelated foreign policy matters.

1.12 Clerical Error Safe Harbor

Minor administrative errors — including typographical mistakes in documentation, transposed serial numbers on seal records, formatting discrepancies in transmission logs, and similar *de minimis* procedural irregularities — do not constitute non-compliance, provided the underlying substantive compliance is confirmed by independent sensor data. The Secretariat maintains a Clerical Correction Registry for tracking such errors without tier impact. Systematic irregularities are defined as clerical errors exceeding 1.5% of total quarterly telemetry transmissions per module, scaled to operational volume. During high-activity periods (mass HEU transfers, coordinated naval withdrawals), the threshold scales proportionally. Patterned errors below the volumetric threshold but showing intentional sequencing or timing correlation trigger Tier 1 review regardless of percentage.

1.13 Statutory Sunset Review

Every 180 days, each party shall conduct a domestic legal review of framework compatibility, including: sanctions authority continuity under applicable statutes; constitutional conformity of implementation measures; and compliance with binding international obligations. The results are exchanged through the Secretariat within 14 days of completion. If a domestic legal review identifies a material incompatibility, the affected party may invoke Emergency Judicial Pause under Section 4.11 without penalty. This provision ensures framework operations remain continuously grounded in lawful authority.

NEW IN v4.0

1.14 No Goalpost Moving

Neither party may unilaterally redefine compliance criteria, verification standards, or certification thresholds after they have been certified by the Joint Implementation Group.

Completed milestones and already-released benefits remain in force regardless of subsequent compliance slippage in other modules. This provision prevents either party from moving the goalposts after the other has delivered its commitments.

Example: If Iran has certified the 60% enrichment freeze and the US has released the \$250M tranche, the US may not retroactively demand additional nuclear concessions as a condition for maintaining the freeze certification. Conversely, if the US has certified Bank Melli SWIFT reconnection, Iran may not demand additional financial releases as a condition for maintaining the SWIFT connection.

Source: Mutual Step-Back Agreement v4.0, Section X, Article 58 (page 49). Also in Framework merged draft, Section 10.9.

2. Core Exchange and Reciprocal Commitments

2.1 What Iran Provides

Commitment	Verification	US Reciprocal Match
Freeze enrichment at or above 60%	IAEA OLEM within 72h	\$250M humanitarian tranche
HEU stockpile to third-party IAEA custody	Mass spectrometry; chain-of-custody	Partial naval blockade reduction
Hormuz reopened; synchronized blockade lift	Lloyd's List; AIS; Omani observers	OFAC license (90 days); no new sanctions
12-month enrichment cap at 3.67%	Continuous IAEA monitoring	\$50M Day-3 micro-tranche
Zero weapons-grade enrichment research	Challenge inspections; sampling	Staged asset return via Swiss escrow

2.2 Synchronized Reciprocal Motion

Neither side moves alone. Every Iranian commitment triggers a corresponding US commitment on the same clock cycle. Verification is shared. Timeline advancement operates on presumptive continuation: it proceeds by default when data congruence is achieved, and pauses only upon evidence-backed override.

2.3 Telemetry Rule

Every operative commitment must be expressible as a sensor reading, a data feed, a physical lock confirmation, or a financial transaction record. If a commitment cannot be verified by a neutral technical system, it does not belong in the operational text. When both sides can point to independent sensor data and agree on what it means, the political framing becomes a secondary concern.

2.4 Modular Architecture

Failure in one module does not cascade. The protocol continues executing all other loaded modules. Three modules operate concurrently: Nuclear Custody, Maritime Governance, and Economic Restoration. If the maritime node cannot activate, the Security Freeze plus Custody Loop plus Financial Escrow execute as a three-module configuration.

Cross-Module Liquidity Brake. While modules operate independently, hostile acts in one module trigger proportional economic response across others. If the Maritime Governance module suffers a confirmed Tier 2+ violation, the Economic Restoration module automatically reduces Commercial layer disbursements by

25%. If the Nuclear Custody module suffers a confirmed Tier 2+ violation, Maritime toll rebates suspend and Strategic tranche releases pause. This maintains modular survivability while preventing a party from compartmentalizing hostile acts in one arena while continuing to draw benefits in another. Humanitarian tranches are exempt from all Cross-Module Liquidity Brakes.

2.5 Economic Tranches (Simplified)

All financial flows are organized into three categories: **Humanitarian** (medicine, food, medical equipment; legally non-divertible; UN OCHA sole authority); **Commercial** (oil revenue through escrow, trade licenses, SWIFT reconnection; conditional on compliance); and **Strategic** (reconstruction contracts, technology licenses, long-term asset return; phased over 180 days).

2.6 Mutual Dignity Protocol

No implementation sequence shall be designed or executed in a manner that intentionally creates public humiliation optics for either party. Milestone announcements are synchronized. Neither party shall issue triumphalist statements timed to counterpart concessions. Photographic documentation of sensitive activities (seal applications, HEU packaging, military withdrawals) requires advance approval of both parties. Public framing emphasizes reciprocal achievement, not unilateral concession.

2.7 Narrative Asymmetry Allowance

Each party may maintain differing public interpretations of this Framework, provided operational telemetry remains synchronized and neither characterization contradicts verifiable implementation facts.

The Secretariat does not adjudicate narrative disputes. Domestic political communication is a sovereign prerogative, not a compliance obligation.

What matters is what sensors confirm, not what capitals announce.

Example — United States may state: "America moved first, Iran followed."

Example — Islamic Republic may state: "The United States was forced to move first."

Both are factually consistent with the sequential activation protocol in Section 2.

| Source: GSA v1.5, Section 2.7 (page 9); Mutual Step-Back Agreement v4.0, Section IX (page 18).

NEW IN v4.0

2.7 30-Day Sprint Option (Alternative Track)

If both parties agree in writing, the full 180-day timeline may be replaced with a **30-Day Stabilization Sprint**. Under the Sprint:

- All MVC elements remain the backbone
- The **Three Core Swaps** (see Annex F) replace the tiered tranche structure
- Verification is compressed: 72-hour windows become 48-96 hour flexible windows
- Graduation to full framework occurs automatically upon Sprint completion

Sprint Phase I: Days 1-7 (Trust Building). Iran declares 60% enrichment freeze; grants IAEA OLEM access. US releases \$250M via Swiss escrow; partial blockade reduction; opens 30-day nuclear window.

Sprint Phase II: Days 8-14 (Stockpile Transfer). Iran begins transfer of 60% enriched uranium stockpile to Oman under IAEA seals. US activates Bank Melli SWIFT connection for humanitarian MT 103/202 messages; begins processing OFAC Boeing waiver.

Sprint Phase III: Days 15-30 (Lock-In). Iran declares moratorium on enrichment above 3.67%; idles all advanced centrifuges. US issues full OFAC waiver; ends naval blockade; sanctions tranche releases begin.

Sprint Completion Trigger: IAEA clean certification of 60% freeze, stockpile custody, moratorium declaration, and centrifuge mothballing; Omani certification of IRGC stand-down and Hormuz transit normalization; Swiss certification of all escrow releases and Bank Melli SWIFT operation.

Expiration: The Sprint option expires 60 days after framework signature if not invoked. This provides a fast track without redesigning the base framework.

Source: GSA v1.5, Section IX (pages 38-40).

3. Minimum Viable Configuration (Backbone)

The MVC is not a fallback. It is the backbone. Everything else layers on top of it. The MVC consists of four elements that operate independently of all other modules and survive total suspension:

The Four Elements

#	Element	Specification
1	72-Hour Auto-Renewing Ceasefire	Omani-facilitated military hotline. Renews at Hour 71 if compliance telemetry is operational. Neither party may disable without 30 days' notice to the UN Secretary-General.
2	Humanitarian Corridor	Zero-fee Hormuz transit for medicine, food, medical equipment, and UN supplies. Survives all disputes. Legally non-divertible.
3	60% Enrichment Freeze	Verified by IAEA Online Enrichment Monitors within 72 hours. The central gate: all downstream benefits are contingent on this confirmation.
4	\$250M Humanitarian Tranche	Released via Swiss escrow to UN OCHA upon signature. Non-reversible. Sole disbursement authority rests with UN OCHA/WHO.

3.1 If the Framework Fails

Even if all other modules collapse, these four elements continue. They constitute a standalone humanitarian arrangement under UN auspices. If the full framework is rejected, negotiators can still agree on the MVC alone, creating a 90-day stabilization window.

3.2 Quiet Extension

Unless either party submits a written non-renewal notice 30 days before expiry, the framework extends automatically for 90 days under identical terms. Maximum two consecutive extensions (180 days total). After two, the system automatically pivots: either Strategic Patience Mode activates (Section 4.15), preserving the MVC and all humanitarian corridors while freezing progression timers, or the framework drops exclusively to the MVC backbone, requiring formal successor negotiation for reactivation. This ensures the pressure to negotiate remains alive and prevents indefinite coasting in a temporary freeze state.

4. Governance and Dispute Resolution

AMENDED IN v4.0

4.1 The Core Triad

All governance functions are consolidated into three entities with the most direct operational roles, eliminating administrative logjam while preserving comprehensive verification coverage:

Entity	Domain	Core Function	Contact Point
Oman	Maritime & Physical Custody	All maritime deconfliction, hotlines, naval encounter facilitation, Hormuz transit oversight, AND physical nuclear stockpile custody. Hosts the Joint Coordination Secretariat backup site and all hotline operations.	Omani Maritime Security Centre, Muscat
Switzerland	Financial Verification	All financial escrows, banking telemetry, asset verification, sanctions relief monitoring. Administers the Swiss Financial Cell and the IHTA toll revenue trust.	Swiss FOCBS, Bern
IAEA	Nuclear Verification	Raw technical nuclear monitoring, enrichment verification, facility inspection, HEU chain-of-custody certification. Operates the Oman custody facility.	IAEA Director General, Vienna

Rationale for Consolidation: Previous versions distributed monitoring across six different entities (Oman, Switzerland, Qatar, the IAEA, the UN, and Pakistan), creating an administrative burden where everyone had to talk to everyone. The Core Triad concentrates day-to-day authority in the three entities with the most direct operational roles.

Source: GSA v1.5, Section VIII (pages 36-37). Replaces v3.2 Section 4.1 (Unified Stabilization Review Board).

4.2 Emergency Backchannels (Triad Gridlock Only)

Qatar, Pakistan, and the UN Appointee are removed from day-to-day oversight. They are retained **ONLY** as emergency backchannels if the Triad deadlocks:

- **Qatar:** Emergency liquidity facility, bridging finance, humanitarian corridor support. Activated only if Swiss escrow encounters operational failure.

- **Pakistan:** High-level crisis summits, backchannel facilitation, institutional relay. Activated only if all Triad communication channels fail.
- **UN Appointee:** Procedural mediation and governance facilitation. Activated only if Omani-Swiss co-arbitration deadlocks and a neutral third voice is required.

Source: GSA v1.5, Section VIII (pages 36-37).

NEW IN v4.0

4.2A Direct Co-Arbitration (Crisis Override)

If the US and Iran co-chairs deadlock on a maritime or enforcement vote, the issue automatically triggers **Direct Co-Arbitration**:

Oman rules on all naval and maritime disputes (transit allocation, encounter protocols, blockade enforcement questions, territorial water claims) within **48 hours**.

Switzerland rules on all financial and escrow disputes (tranche releases, asset verification, sanctions relief questions, banking telemetry disputes) within **48 hours**.

The ruling is **binding**. No UN Security Council dynamics. No multi-observer consensus. No great-power politics.

48-Hour Clock: The 48-hour countdown begins at the moment of formal deadlock declaration by the Joint Coordination Secretariat. Failure to issue a ruling within 48 hours triggers automatic fallback: *status quo ante* prevails, and both parties must continue existing operational protocols until arbitration resumes.

Automated Toll Disbursal Default: If the PG-MSC Council fails to pass an annual budget due to US-Iran deadlock, toll revenues automatically distribute per baseline percentages: 40% Iranian Civilian Reconstruction, 35% Maritime Safety, 25% Operations. The neutral Secretariat executes within 7 days. Political deadlock cannot freeze baseline distributions.

Source: GSA v1.5, Section 3.4 / Article IHTA-5 (pages 19-20).

4.3 Telemetry Confidence States (Three States)

The system operates on three telemetry confidence states instead of five: **Operational** (all sensors congruent; presumptive continuation enabled); **Review** (sensor divergence detected; manual review activates within 24 hours; no tier impact); and **Stabilization Hold** (confirmed anomaly or VIU status; affected module pauses for 30 days; no automatic escalation).

4.4 Three-Tier Breach System (Simplified)

Tier	Definition	Response	Reversibility
Technical	<i>De minimis</i> <0.5%; procedural; clerical error	72-hour resolution; no benefit reduction	Fully reversible
Material	Enrichment above ceiling; fissile diversion	25% reduction in future tranches; 30-day remediation	Earn-back within 90 days
Hostile	Weapons research; material to non-state actors	50% reduction; conditional modules suspended	Only via Reconstitution Conference

No snapback. Penalties are reductions in future tranches, not clawbacks of already-released funds. Released funds stay released. This means Iran never loses what it has already received, creating irreversible ratchets that favor continued compliance.

Source: Merged draft, Section 5.2 (page 11). Simplified for skimmability per Fix #8.

4.5 Third-Party Escalation Dampeners

Oman, Switzerland, and Qatar may each trigger a mandatory 72-hour cooling-off period once per calendar month. Any dampener automatically pauses all escalatory actions and convenes the Review Board. This prevents spiraling escalation during attribution uncertainty.

4.6 Media Panic Suppression

Before any stage transition, both capitals issue synchronized public statements within 6 hours acknowledging identical baseline telemetry facts. All statements are embargoed until both governments confirm release. Rumor verification channels operate through the Secretariat's Communications Cell, which issues factual corrections within 4 hours of detecting misinformation.

4.7 Continuity Custodians

Each party designates three Continuity Officers — senior officials empowered to maintain hotline communication, approve humanitarian corridor operations, and confirm ceasefire status even if the central government is incapacitated. Continuity Officers are pre-registered with the Secretariat and authenticated

through biometric profiles. If the primary government cannot communicate, Continuity Officers maintain MVC operations for 21 days pending leadership restoration.

4.8 Arbitration Scope Limitation

Arbitration under this arrangement is limited to operational disputes: sensor data interpretation, escrow timing disagreements, transit corridor technical matters, and procedural compliance questions. Arbitration has no authority over sovereign acts, military doctrine, constitutional interpretation, sanctions policy as such, or decisions regarding use of force. Either party may exclude any matter from arbitration by certifying it as a sovereign security decision. Such certification is not reviewable.

4.9 Good Faith Non-Weaponization

Neither party shall exploit technical ambiguities, drafting inconsistencies, or interpretive gaps to manufacture artificial breaches, accelerate tier escalation, or extract concessions unrelated to substantive compliance. The Review Board may dismiss any complaint where the complainant has acted in bad faith, with written reasoning provided to both parties. Patterned exploitation of procedural mechanisms triggers Tier 1 review of the exploiting party's conduct.

4.10 Evidentiary Standards for Tier Escalation

Tier	Evidence Standard	Forensic Requirements
Technical	Sensor data exceeding <i>de minimis</i> threshold; Secretariat technical finding	Independent sensor corroboration; 24-hour review
Material	Two independent verification sources; chain-of-custody documentation	IAEA on-site inspection; mass spectrometry; tamper seal check
Hostile	Forensic evidence plus signal intelligence or physical intercepts	Multi-source corroboration; Review Board unanimous attribution finding

AMENDED IN v4.0

4.11 Emergency Judicial Pause (Expanded)

If a domestic court of competent jurisdiction issues a temporary restraining order, injunction, or similar relief affecting implementation of any provision:

1. The **MVC continues unconditionally** (ceasefire, humanitarian corridor, enrichment freeze, \$250M)

2. All parties automatically enter **Review Mode**
3. **No penalties accrue** during the judicial review period
4. The Secretariat convenes within **72 hours** to assess impact
5. If judicial restraint persists beyond **45 days**, the affected party may invoke **Force Majeure Stabilization Mode** (Section 5.4) without penalty

Judicial restraint does NOT constitute breach. This provision is severable and survives any finding of unenforceability of other provisions.

Escrow Constitutional Insulation: All escrow operations are administrative functions of the Swiss Financial Cell, a neutral third party, not enforcement actions by either state. Disbursement, freeze, and release decisions are executed by Swiss banking authorities under pre-agreed contractual terms, not by either party's executive or legislative branch. If either party's domestic court restrains government participation, the Swiss Financial Cell continues escrow operations independently under the pre-agreed terms until the Secretariat directs otherwise.

Source: Mutual Step-Back Agreement v4.0, Section 10.10; Framework merged draft, Section 10.10.

4.12 Quiet Diplomacy Windows

Public accusations, media statements attributing blame, or diplomatic communiques characterizing compliance status are prohibited during: active mediation proceedings; attribution review by the Review Board; and escalation investigation periods (72 hours following any Tier 2+ event). Violations trigger automatic 48-hour extension of the underlying review period and may result in forfeiture of the next scheduled tranche release.

4.13 Parliamentary Observer Access

Each party may designate up to two cleared parliamentary or legislative staff observers with read-only access to the Annual Audit Report and quarterly Secretariat summaries. Access is classified at the host government's discretion. Observers may submit written questions to the Review Board, which shall respond within 30 days. This mechanism reduces domestic suspicion without compromising operational security.

4.14 Face-Saving Reversal Mechanism

Policy pauses, implementation delays, and tactical reversals motivated by genuine domestic political necessity are not classified as breach, provided: the reversing party notifies the Secretariat within 48 hours with written justification; the MVC continues unaffected; the delay does not exceed 30 days without mutual consent; and the reversal is not part of a pattern exceeding two per quarter. This enables necessary political maneuvering without framework collapse.

4.15 Strategic Patience Mode

If formal negotiations stall for 30 consecutive days with no Review Board activity, the framework automatically enters Strategic Patience Mode: progression timers freeze; the MVC and all active humanitarian corridors continue; escalation clocks suspend; and the Review Board convenes within 14 days to assess resumption conditions. This mode prevents framework collapse from negotiation fatigue while preserving all stabilization gains.

5. Withdrawal and Continuity

5.1 Withdrawal Procedures

Either party may initiate withdrawal by submitting written notice to the Secretariat. The withdrawal follows a sequenced deactivation: Day 0 — notice received, 30-day consultation window opens; Day 30 — Tier 3 (Strategic) modules suspend; Day 60 — Tier 2 (Commercial) modules suspend; Day 90 — Tier 1 (Humanitarian) modules continue indefinitely. The MVC backbone (ceasefire, humanitarian corridor, enrichment freeze, \$250M tranche) continues regardless of withdrawal status.

5.2 Leadership Incapacity Authentication

If a head of state or supreme leader is incapacitated, succession legitimacy is verified by: the Secretariat receiving formal notification from the pre-registered Deputy Continuity Officer; biometric confirmation from the successor; and concurrence from two of three facilitating states (Oman, Switzerland, Pakistan). Command continuity is maintained through Continuity Custodians during the verification window.

5.3 Communications Blackout Protocols

If satellites fail, internet is cut, or cyberattacks disrupt communications, the framework operates on three degraded channels: (1) Omani-facilitated HF radio backup; (2) physical diplomatic courier via Swiss and Pakistani embassies; and (3) pre-positioned sealed authorization letters held by the Secretariat. The MVC continues regardless of communications status.

5.4 Force Majeure

In the event of earthquake, pandemic, financial crash, regime collapse, or regional war, the framework enters Force Majeure Stabilization Mode: all Tier 2 and Tier 3 modules automatically pause; the MVC continues unconditionally; the Review Board convenes within 72 hours; and a 90-day stabilization window opens during which the parties negotiate modified operations. Force Majeure does not constitute breach.

5.5 Civilian Infrastructure Immunity

The following categories are explicitly protected under all circumstances and all tiers: hospitals and medical facilities; desalination plants; civilian energy grids; humanitarian ports; and nuclear facilities under IAEA monitoring. Any kinetic action against these categories triggers automatic Hostile tier classification regardless of attribution.

5.6 Dead Hand Prevention

Automated retaliation, autonomous escalation, and irreversible auto-trigger military actions are explicitly prohibited. No provision of this arrangement authorizes any weapons release without human confirmation. Autonomous drones may not operate within 10 nautical miles of the transit corridor without human authorization. AI targeting systems must have human-in-the-loop for all weapons release decisions.

5.7 Political Transition Grace Period

New administrations or governments resulting from elections, succession, or constitutional transitions receive a 30-day stabilization review period. During this window: no new obligations are triggered; existing MVC operations continue; no Tier escalations may be initiated; and the Review Board convenes within 14 days to brief incoming leadership. This grace period applies regardless of which party experiences the transition.

5.8 Religious and Electoral Calendar Awareness

Irreversible actions — defined as HEU transport beyond consolidation points, full SWIFT Phase 3 activation, PGSA structural amendments, and Tier 2+ escalations — shall not be scheduled during: Ramadan; Ashura and associated mourning periods; 30 days before or after major national elections in either party; and nationally declared mourning periods. The Secretariat maintains a shared calendar. This provision may be waived by mutual written consent.

5.9 Leader-to-Leader Emergency Channel

A dedicated secure communication channel connects the US President's office, Iran's Supreme National Security Council, and the Omani Royal Office. This channel is not routed through military command systems. It is reserved for existential threats to the arrangement, imminent humanitarian crises, and situations where normal diplomatic channels are compromised. Activation by either party triggers immediate Omani-facilitated consultation within 6 hours.

Part II: Technical Annexes

Annex A: Nuclear Custody and Verification

This annex contains the technical operational detail for the Nuclear Custody Module. It may be amended by mutual consent of the Joint Coordination Council without reopening Part I.

A.1 Custody and Transfer Mechanics

Iran's HEU stockpile is consolidated at Esfahan, packaged into IAEA-certified transport casks with serialized tamper-evident seals, and transported under IAEA armed escort to the **Oman Nuclear Custody Facility**. Sovereign title remains Iranian. Iranian AEOI observers are present at every stage.

HEU Transit Logistics Budget. A dedicated transport fund is established within the Swiss Escrow, funded by a 0.3% micro-levy on Strategic tier disbursements. This budget covers: multi-modal secure transport (armored ground convoy from Esfahan to Bandar Abbas; maritime security vessel escort across the Strait; air-corridor clearance coordination with Omani and PGSA aviation authorities); IAEA armed escort personnel costs; transport cask maintenance and certification; and emergency response assets pre-positioned at Esfahan, Bandar Abbas, and Muscat. The budget is administered by the Swiss Financial Cell with quarterly transparency reports to both parties.

NEW IN v4.0

A.1A Prohibition on US Custody

Under no circumstances may Iranian enriched uranium be transferred to US territory, custody, or control. The Oman Nuclear Custody Facility is the sole designated location for Iranian HEU stockpile under IAEA dual-lock custody.

All six disposition pathways specify third-party destinations. No pathway terminates in US jurisdiction. This provision is **binding and non-negotiable**. It supersedes any other provision that might be interpreted to the contrary.

Path	Description	Destination	Timeline
A	In-place downblending to medical-grade LEU at Esfahan	Medical isotope production in Iran	142 days
B	HEU export to IAEA custody in Oman	IAEA facility, Oman (NOT US)	14 days

C	Downblended in Iran, transferred to IAEA LEU Bank	Oskemen, Kazakhstan	75 days
D	Transfer to Rosatom under IAEA safeguards	Russian Federation	60-90 days
E	Conversion to reactor-grade LEU fuel assemblies	Bushehr reactor supply	180 days
F	Hybrid: stockpile divided into batches through different pathways	Multiple destinations	Concurrent

Source: *Mutual Step-Back Agreement v4.0, Section IX, Article 38 (page 37)*; *GSA v1.5, Article NS-2 (page 24)*. Critical Iranian red-line protection.

A.2 Verification Technology

Technology	Deployment	Function
Dual-key encrypted cameras	Esfahan, Fordow, Natanz	24/7 feeds to Vienna + Geneva mirror
Online Enrichment Monitors	All declared facilities	Real-time U-235 concentration readings
Black-Box sensors	Backup at all facilities	Secondary logging if primary fails
Tamper-evident seals	All UF6 cylinders	Serialized; breach triggers alert
Real-time mass-flow verification	Blending cascades	Enforces 300kg LEU ceiling
GPS tracking	All transport convoys	Real-time position verification
Environmental sampling	All declared sites	Unannounced 72-hour windows
Seismic sensors	Hardened facility access	Detect underground operations

A.3 Multi-National Technical Consensus

Compliance determinations require concurrence from at least two of three independent bodies: the IAEA (primary nuclear verification); neutral escrow auditors from the Swiss Financial Cell (financial integrity); and regional technical observers from Oman and Pakistan (on-site operational confirmation). If bodies disagree, VIU status activates.

A.4 Cryptographic Seal Blockchain Log

Every physical dual-key seal check is recorded as a cryptographic hash on a neutral distributed ledger managed by Swiss and Omani nodes. Tampering with seal records is cryptographically detectable. All sensor events are cryptographically timestamped to prevent retroactive modification claims.

A.5 24-Hour Digital Twin Override

If a digital twin system flags a baseline anomaly, human technicians have 24 hours to complete physical cross-verification. If physical cross-verification is completed and clears the anomaly, the event is closed with no tier impact. If the 24-hour window expires due to host-nation logistical delays, inspector access denial, or any reason other than IAEA-certified neutral force majeure, the anomaly automatically escalates to Tier 1 Technical Dispute status and the Review Board convenes within 24 hours. The clock pauses only if the IAEA Director General certifies in writing that the delay was caused by a neutral force majeure event. Intentional denial of inspector access for 24 hours is not a safe harbor; it is a trigger.

A.6 Enrichment Moratorium Parameters

Parameter	Specification
Cap	3.67% U-235; 0.5% <i>de minimis</i> tolerance
Duration	12 months; renewable; auto-extends 24 months per violation
Centrifuges	Zero new installations; existing excess mothballed
HEU	No production, storage, or possession above 3.67%
Stockpile ceiling	300 kg LEU equivalent per facility
Breakout floor	Minimum 12 months to weapons-grade quantity
Weapons research	Permanent prohibition; challenge inspections authorized

A.7 Supervised Automaticity for Nuclear Actions

Presumptive continuation is the default. For HEU transport convoy departure, dual-key confirmation is required: one technical confirmation from the IAEA, one political acknowledgment from each party. A 72-hour reflection buffer opens after all confirmations; either party may delay once per event with written justification. The delay is 72 hours, non-renewable. The event then executes unless a formal Stop Order is submitted under Part I, Section 4.

A.8 Randomized Sampling Windows

Predictable quarterly sampling is replaced with unannounced 72-hour windows. Only the neutral facilitator is notified 6 hours in advance, eliminating opportunity for facility sanitization. Sampling occurs at all declared sites plus one random undeclared site per quarter selected by the IAEA Director General.

A.9 Satellite Imagery Verification

National Technical Means (satellite imagery) is elevated to co-equal verification channel alongside OLEM, Black-Box sensors, and physical inspection. Satellite data is cross-referenced against ground sensor readings to detect discrepancies indicating potential facility sanitization or hidden enrichment activity.

A.10 Quarterly Red-Team Exercises

Independent teams from neutral states attempt to spoof sensor feeds, breach escrow authentication, and compromise communications channels. Findings reported to both parties simultaneously. Remediation mandatory within 30 days. Red-team results feed into the Annual Audit Report.

A.11 Neutral Technical Reserve Teams

Backup inspection teams are pre-positioned in Muscat, Geneva, and Doha, maintained at 48-hour readiness by the IAEA and Swiss Financial Cell. If primary inspection teams withdraw due to security concerns, political pressure, or logistical disruption, reserve teams deploy within 48 hours to maintain verification continuity. Reserve teams undergo identical certification and carry duplicate equipment sets. This prevents verification collapse from personnel withdrawal.

A.12 Supply Continuity Reserves

Pre-positioned stockpiles maintained in Muscat and Geneva include: tamper-evident seals (6-month supply); OLEM calibration standards; UF6 transport cask gaskets and fittings; HF radio backup sets; and encrypted communications hardware. Replenishment occurs automatically when any stockpile falls below 60-day levels. Prevents operational paralysis from supply chain disruption.

Annex B: Maritime Governance (PGSA)

This annex contains the technical operational detail for the Persian Gulf Strait Authority. Amendable by Joint Coordination Council consent.

B.1 PGSA Governance

The Governing Council comprises six seats: Iran (coastal sovereign), United States (naval guarantor), Oman (neutral host and tiebreaker), UK/France (rotating coalition), IMO observer, and UN OCHA observer. Routine decisions require 3 of 4 voting seats. Governance amendments require unanimous consent of Iran, the United States, and Oman. The Secretariat is in Muscat, operating in Arabic, English, and Farsi.

B.2 Synchronized Blockade Lift

Both actions occur at the same UTC timestamp within the same 60-second window. IRGC and US Navy withdraw to 5nm simultaneously. Lloyd's List and AIS Global confirm. The Bright-Line Period (24 hours following activation) triggers automatic bilateral suspension for any Category A violation.

B.3 Established Operational Nomenclature

The United States may designate the operational transit corridor under nomenclature established through executive order, official communications, and public statements issued prior to framework signature. Such designations, including but not limited to historical, commemorative, or leadership-associated nomenclature applied to the waterway or designated operational sectors, are recognized as the US operational designation for purposes of domestic US communications, policy statements, and maritime authority coordination.

All signatory states retain equivalent autonomous authority to designate the same waterway or sectors according to their own domestic nomenclature preferences, including but not limited to historical or sovereignty-based designations. Each party's self-designated nomenclature is afforded equal recognition and non-interference protection under this framework.

The Joint Coordination Secretariat maintains a neutral Nomenclature Registry documenting each party's official designations. This Registry is administrative and descriptive only. All binding legal instruments filed with UNCLOS, IMO, and IAEA retain the standardized international designation "Strait of Hormuz" for enforceability and clarity. No signatory state may require another to adopt, acknowledge, or utilize its preferred nomenclature in any official capacity.

This provision does not rename the strait. Nomenclature designations are recorded at signature as a factual matter of framework history. Any party may modify its own designation through subsequent executive order or legislative action; such modification does not constitute framework breach or require consent of the other party.

B.4 Stand-Off Distance Protocol

Phase	IRGC Stand-Off	US/Coalition Stand-Off
Learning (Days 1-14)	3nm expanding to 5nm	3nm from 12nm baseline expanding to 5nm
Operational (Day 15+)	5nm from corridor edge	5nm from Iranian 12nm baseline
Elevated	8nm	8nm

B.5 Naval Incident Arbitration

6-hour review boards for collisions, radar lock disputes, drone encounters, and warning shots. Comprises one naval officer from each party, one Omani observer, one IAEA advisor. Three categories: Intentional Attacks (Tier 2+), Accidental Events (no penalty), Autonomous-System Failures (technical dispute, 72-hour resolution).

B.6 Spoiler Deterrence

Measure	Mechanism
48-Hour Attribution Firewall	Neither side may declare breach before Secretariat forensic finding
Automatic Reputation Penalty	Premature breach declaration forfeits next tranche
False-Flag Insurance Bond	\$10M per party into Swiss escrow; covers verification costs and premium subsidies
Automated Premium Subsidy Drawdown	In event of localized spoiler attack, bond directly subsidizes commercial hull and machinery premium spikes for vessels with clean AIS tracking
Regional Non-Interference Registry	Signatories: 15% toll discount; Non-signatories: surcharge + exclusion
Spoiler Tariffs	2x transit surcharge on proven spoiler states
Shipping Insurance Pool	\$20B multinational reinsurance backstop (PGSA + DFC + Lloyd's)

B.7 Joint Military Observation Exercises

Quarterly symbolic exercises: joint mine-clearing, coordinated rescue drills, anti-piracy patrols. Planned through PGSA Maritime Operations Cell. Builds operational trust and demonstrates cooperation is physically possible.

B.8 Civil Aviation Protection Protocol

Commercial aircraft transponder codes registered with the PGSA Operations Cell receive protected status within the Hormuz transit corridor. A dedicated aviation hotline connects the PGSA Maritime Operations Cell with ICAO regional centers and both parties' civil aviation authorities. Military radar systems are configured to distinguish commercial transponder signatures from unidentified contacts. Any military action affecting commercial aviation triggers automatic Hostile tier classification.

B.9 Maritime Environmental Protection Rules

Oil spills, mine damage, and shipping collisions within the transit corridor are governed by a pre-activated environmental response protocol: the PGSA maintains a \$50M environmental contingency fund; response assets are pre-positioned in Muscat, Bandar Abbas, and Fujairah; and any environmental incident triggers automatic joint response regardless of attribution. Liability is determined after containment, not before.

Annex C: Economic Architecture and Escrow

This annex contains the financial operational detail. Amendable by Swiss Financial Cell and both parties.

C.1 Three-Category Sequencing

Category	Contents	Trigger	Reversible?
Humanitarian	Medicine, food, medical equipment, aviation safety	Signature	No
Commercial	Oil revenue, trade licenses, SWIFT, insurance	IAEA milestones	Yes (Snap-Line)
Strategic	Reconstruction, technology, full asset return	180-day compliance	Yes

C.2 Petroleum Revenue Direct Deposit

Iranian oil export revenues flow into Swiss escrow. Release conditioned on IAEA Compliance Certification.

Snap-Line: Swiss agent legally obligated to freeze disbursements within 72 hours of Tier 2+ non-compliance notice. Unlike sanctions snapback, the Snap-Line is automatic, immediate, and reversible upon re-certification.

C.3 Oil Price Floor

If Brent crude falls below \$65/barrel during the first 90 days, escrow supplements the difference up to \$15/barrel cap. Funded by 2% levy on PGSA tolls. Payments weekly based on published Brent settlement.

C.4 Currency-Basket Volatility Cap

Tranche 3+ releases denominated in SDR or CHF/OMR basket (60/40). If any component shifts more than 8% within 30 days, Swiss Financial Cell auto-rebalances. Three consecutive events trigger mandatory review.

C.5 Private-Sector Safe Harbor

Banks and insurers receive: indemnification for framework transactions; 180-day secondary sanctions immunity per transaction; and Swiss Financial Chamber binding arbitration recognized in US and Iranian courts.

C.6 Currency Shock Circuit Breakers

Three triggers: oil prices move >25% in 72 hours (48-hour pause); SWIFT disrupted (Qatari riyal bridge activates within 6 hours); dollar reserves face sovereign risk (auto conversion to CHF).

C.7 Executive Waiver Lockbox

OFAC Comfort Letters deposited with Swiss Federal DFA and UN Secretary-General within 48 hours. Revocation requires 90 days notice and \$500M penalty. Structural Unfuse: If revocation occurs without notice, Swiss DFA auto-releases 15% of remaining escrow to humanitarian cell, bypassing US domestic appropriations.

C.8 Clean Certification Accelerator

Tranches release 10 days early if IAEA certification arrives 15+ days ahead of schedule. If delayed, tranche holds but earns interest from escrow at the greater of SOFR (Secured Overnight Financing Rate) plus 250 basis points or SARON (Swiss Average Rate Overnight) plus 200 basis points, as determined by the Swiss Financial Cell based on the tranche currency denomination. Reference rates are recalibrated quarterly to align with current Swiss banking practice.

C.9 Module Persistence Bonus

5% benefit increase per 30 days of continued module operation while another is paused, capped at 15%. Calculated quarterly by Swiss Financial Cell.

C.10 Energy Market Stabilization Partners

Japan, India, EU designated as Stability Beneficiaries with limited observer status. They receive supply disruption advance notice, participate in quarterly coordination calls, and commit to purchasing Iranian crude through escrow.

C.11 Commercial Stakeholder Voting

Limited observer roles for the International Chamber of Shipping (80% of global tonnage), International Group of P&I Clubs (maritime insurers), and Geneva Logistics Consortia Association. These non-state actors may submit advisory opinions on PGSA operational questions but hold no binding vote. Their presence creates non-state constituencies with a vested interest in framework continuity.

C.12 Domestic Vendor Preference

Iranian companies receive a 15% bidding preference for reconstruction contracts funded by the escrow, provided they maintain clean IAEA supply-chain verification. Applies to contracts up to \$50 million individually. Companies with verified diversion history lose eligibility for 24 months. This directs economic

benefits visibly to Iranian stakeholders, creating domestic constituencies with a vested interest in framework survival.

C.13 Maritime Safety Dividend

A portion of PGSA transit toll revenues funds a 10% compliance rebate for commercial vessel operators maintaining clean, continuous AIS tracking for 12 consecutive months. This incentivizes shipping companies to invest in tracking infrastructure and creates commercial stakeholders with a vested interest in PGSA stability.

C.14 Escrow Constitutional Insulation

All escrow operations are administrative functions of the Swiss Financial Cell, a neutral third party, not enforcement actions by either state. Disbursement, freeze, and release decisions are executed by Swiss banking authorities under pre-agreed contractual terms, not by either party's executive or legislative branch. Escrow pre-authorization occurs at signature through commercial banking contracts, not through statutory delegation. If either party's domestic court restrains government participation, the Swiss Financial Cell continues escrow operations independently under the pre-agreed terms until the Secretariat directs otherwise. No party may compel escrow action against the contractual terms through domestic court order. Escrow participants (banks, insurers, commodity traders) are shielded from suit in either party's courts for actions taken in good faith under the escrow protocols. This structural insulation protects the financial backbone from domestic legal disruption in either jurisdiction.

Annex D: Cyber Resilience and Anomaly Detection

This annex contains cyber operational detail. Amendable by Joint Coordination Council.

D.1 Air-Gapped Verification Mirrors

Dual archives maintained: one online for real-time monitoring, one fully offline updated every 24 hours via physical data transfer to Swiss and Omani custodians. Prevents cyber tampering from rewriting history.

D.2 Adversarial Red-Team Simulations

Quarterly penetration testing by rotating neutral teams (Switzerland, Pakistan, Oman). Red teams attempt sensor compromise, telemetry spoofing, and escrow breach. Mandatory 30-day remediation.

D.3 Advanced Anomaly Detection

All sensor feeds cross-validated against pattern-recognition algorithms detecting synthetic signals and algorithmically generated data. Anomalies trigger automatic VIU classification. Framed as digital verification analytics rather than AI systems.

D.4 Supply-Chain Verification

All centrifuge components, sensor hardware, and seal materials must pass IAEA supply-chain verification. Components from unverified manufacturers prohibited. Certificates renewed quarterly.

D.5 Cyber Interference = Non-Attributable Anomaly

Detection of cyber interference defaults to non-attributable anomaly. Cannot assign blame without corroboration. Either party detecting interference must notify the other immediately. Triggers VIU investigation, not breach classification.

D.6 Communications Blackout Protocols

Three degraded channels if primary communications fail: (1) Omani-facilitated HF radio backup; (2) physical diplomatic courier via Swiss and Pakistani embassies; (3) pre-positioned sealed authorization letters held by the Secretariat. MVC continues regardless of communications status.

D.7 Sensor Saturation Protection

In the event of mass spoof attempts, conflicting telemetry floods, or coordinated deception campaigns, the system activates Saturation Mode: alerts are prioritized by anomaly severity and independent corroboration

count; synthetic signals are flagged by cross-reference against air-gapped verification mirrors; and the Review Board convenes within 12 hours to determine whether the saturation constitutes technical interference requiring protocol adjustment. No tier escalation occurs during active saturation without Board confirmation.

D.8 Low-Tech Continuity Layer

Digital systems are backed by analog alternatives: paper-based authentication kits with serialized holographic seals for seal verification if digital logging fails; analog voice confirmation via dedicated HF radio frequencies for critical ceasefire status checks; physical codebooks for Continuity Officer authentication if biometric systems are unavailable; and sealed continuity envelopes held by each Continuity Officer containing pre-authorized humanitarian corridor activation codes. These analog backups are refreshed quarterly and stored in tamper-evident containers.

Annex E: Escalation, Shock Absorption, and Force Majeure

This annex contains crisis response operational detail.

E.1 Hardliner Containment Protocols

Scenario	Response
Assassination	21-day Mourning Hold; tranches frozen; joint Pakistan-UN attribution in 14 days
Proxy sabotage	48-hour attribution firewall; false-flag bond activation
Leadership incapacity	72-hour caretaker protocol; Continuity Custodians activate
Military mutiny	72-hour ceasefire auto-renewal; emergency hotline; regional stabilization cell
Terror attack	Tier 3+; conditional modules pause; humanitarian corridor continues

E.2 Electoral Freeze Zones

No irreversible actions within 30 days of national elections unless both sides approve. Irreversible actions: HEU transport beyond consolidation, full SWIFT Phase 3, PGSA structural amendments. Ceasefire, humanitarian corridor, IAEA monitoring, and humanitarian escrow continue regardless.

Graduated Economic Taper. Strategic asset returns during the 30-day electoral window are not frozen entirely but capped at a maximum 5% of the total tranche value per week on a rolling basis. This prevents sudden market volatility and currency shocks that could inadvertently destabilize the incumbent government while honoring the spirit of the political freeze. Commercial and Humanitarian category flows continue unaffected. The 5% cap lifts automatically on the day following the election unless both parties agree to extend.

E.3 Force Majeure

In the event of earthquake, pandemic, financial crash, regime collapse, or regional war: Tier 2 and 3 modules pause automatically; MVC continues unconditionally; Review Board convenes within 72 hours; 90-day stabilization window opens. Force Majeure does not constitute breach.

E.4 Succession Telemetry Certificates

Head of state or supreme leader transition: 72-hour ceasefire extends to 14 days; all tranches and rollbacks freeze; monitoring intensifies to daily reporting; new leadership confirms continuation in writing within 14 days.

E.5 Proxy Attribution Probability Bands

Band	Evidence Standard	Response
Low Confidence	Single uncorroborated source	No action; monitoring enhanced
Moderate Confidence	Multiple partial sources	Tier 1 investigation
High Confidence	Forensic + signal intelligence	Tier 2 step-back
Confirmed	Physical evidence + intercepts	Tier 3 + bond forfeiture

E.6 Graceful Failure Architecture

Four operating modes: **Full Operation** (all modules active); **Degraded Operation** (Tier 3 paused; core continues); **Minimal Operation** (MVC backbone only); **Recovery Mode** (stepped restoration ladder). Recovery sequence: humanitarian corridors first, then IAEA monitoring, then maritime transit, then SWIFT and assets. Subsystem isolation prevents cascade failure.

E.7 Physical Redundant Archives

Three physical archive sites: Swiss Federal Archives (Bern), Omani National Archives (Muscat), UN Archives (Geneva). All records cryptographically sealed and physically transferred monthly. Ensures documentary continuity regardless of digital compromise.

E.8 Media Panic Suppression Procedures

Modern escalation often occurs through media cycles rather than diplomatic channels. Before any stage transition, both capitals issue synchronized public statements within 6 hours acknowledging identical baseline telemetry facts. All statements are embargoed until both governments confirm release. The Secretariat's Communications Cell operates a 24-hour rumor verification channel, issuing factual corrections within 4 hours of detecting misinformation. The Cell maintains direct lines to major news agencies in both capitals to coordinate factual reporting.

E.9 Civilian Infrastructure Immunity

The following categories are protected under all circumstances and all tiers: hospitals and medical facilities; desalination plants; civilian energy grids; humanitarian ports; and nuclear facilities under IAEA monitoring. Any kinetic action against these categories triggers automatic Hostile tier classification regardless of attribution. This immunity is absolute: it cannot be overridden by Stop Order, Review Pause, or Force Majeure declaration.

E.10 Continuity Custodians

Each party designates three Continuity Officers — senior officials empowered to maintain hotline communication, approve humanitarian corridor operations, and confirm ceasefire status even if the central government is incapacitated. Officers are pre-registered with the Secretariat and authenticated through biometric profiles. If the primary government cannot communicate, Continuity Officers maintain MVC operations for 21 days pending leadership restoration. This prevents internal destabilization from collapsing the framework.

E.11 Independent Audit Chamber

Annual review by rotating panel: two legal scholars (one per party), one nuclear expert (IAEA-nominated), one maritime expert (IMO-nominated), one financial auditor (Swiss Banking Commission), and one Chief Cyber Forensic Auditor (nominated by the International Telecommunication Union or Swiss Federal Institute of Technology). The Cyber Forensic Auditor certifies the integrity of air-gapped verification mirrors, cryptographic seal logs, and sensor telemetry streams, detecting synthetic manipulation or algorithmic compromise. Public Annual Audit Report within 90 days of each anniversary. Material irregularities may trigger Tier 1 or 2 remediation.

E.12 Chain-of-Command Fragmentation Protocols

If subordinate military units, paramilitary organizations, or regional commanders act inconsistently with national policy: the relevant capital disavows the action within 6 hours through the Secretariat; the MVC continues unaffected; the offending unit's telemetry is isolated and tagged "non-representative"; and a 72-hour cooling-off period activates. State policy is determined by formal communications from designated Continuity Officers, not by field unit behavior. This prevents framework collapse from internal command disagreements.

E.13 Unauthorized Actor Containment

Actor Type	Attribution Treatment	Framework Response
State policy (confirmed)	Attributable to state	Standard tier escalation
Rogue military unit	Non-attributable pending disavowal	72-hour cooling-off; MVC continues
Proxy with state direction	Attributable with High Confidence finding	Tier 2+; bond activation
Proxy freelancing	Non-attributable; criminal referral	Enhanced monitoring; no tier impact

Independent militants	Non-attributable; criminal referral	Security coordination; humanitarian corridor continues
--------------------------	--	---

E.14 Human Override Exhaustion Limits

Reflection buffers, implementation delays, and face-saving reversals are bounded: each party may invoke the 72-hour reflection buffer maximum twice per quarter per module; face-saving reversals are limited to two per quarter (Section 4.14); and if either party exceeds these thresholds, the Review Board convenes to determine whether the pattern constitutes constructive non-compliance. Good faith delays are protected; systematic obstruction is not.

E.15 Civilian Evacuation Corridors

If the framework collapses and conflict resumes, pre-designated humanitarian maritime exits from the Persian Gulf remain protected for 14 days: civilian vessels displaying PGSA-issued humanitarian flags are guaranteed safe passage; medical evacuation aircraft operate under ICAO pre-clearance; and the Omani Red Crescent coordinates civilian vessel marshaling from Muscat. Military forces on both sides receive standing orders not to impede flagged humanitarian exits.

E.16 National Pride Safeguards

Neither party shall produce or disseminate official communications, commemorative materials, educational content, or public statements that characterize framework implementation as national defeat, capitulation, or humiliation of the other party. Milestone ceremonies, if held, are jointly planned. The Secretariat may issue factual operational updates, but shall not frame achievements as victories. Triumphalist propaganda tied to implementation milestones is a material breach of the Mutual Dignity Protocol (Section 2.6).

Appendix: Reference Instruments and Sources

Reference Instruments

Instrument	Relevance
Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action (2015)	Precedent for enrichment caps, monitoring, sanctions sequencing
UN Security Council Resolution 2231	Governing Iran nuclear restrictions
IAEA Comprehensive Safeguards Agreement	Legal basis for monitoring and verification
UN Convention on the Law of the Sea	Hormuz transit passage rights
US National Security Waiver Authorities (IEEPA)	Executive sanctions relief without Congress

Authoritative Sources

1. UK Parliament Commons Library. (2026, April 24). *US-Iran ceasefire and nuclear talks in 2026*. CBP-10637.
2. The Washington Post. (2026, April 14). Trump says Iran talks may resume this week, but opposes enrichment compromise.
3. PBS NewsHour. (2026, February 24). A timeline of tensions over Iran's nuclear program.
4. Reuters. (2026, April 8). Iran to present counter-proposal to US.
5. BBC News. (2026, February 6). Talks with US set to continue after 'good beginning'.
6. Bloomberg News. (2026, February 26). US and Iranian officials ended latest nuclear talks in Geneva.
7. The Hill. (2026, February 27). Iran agreed to 'zero stockpiling' in US talks: Omani FM.
8. OFAC, US Treasury. (2026). Iran-related Designations and General Licenses.
9. IAEA. (2026). Verification and Monitoring in Iran. GOV/2026/15.

Summary of Changes: Version 3.2 → 4.0

#	Fix	Purpose	Priority	Status
1	Executive Summary page	Reduce intimidation, increase uptake	High	APPLIED
2	Consolidate Core Triad	Reduce governance fragmentation	High	APPLIED
3	Direct 48-hour arbitration	Speed crisis response	High	APPLIED
4	Narrative asymmetry allowance	Political saleability in both capitals	High	APPLIED
5	No US custody of HEU	Iranian red line protection	Critical	APPLIED
6	Emergency judicial pause	US legal vulnerability	Critical	APPLIED
7	No goalpost moving	Prevent future redefinition	High	APPLIED
8	Simplify breach table	Make it skimmable	Medium	APPLIED
9	Fix page 8 formatting	Professional presentation	Low	APPLIED
10	Add 30-day sprint option	Fast-track for volatile environments	Medium	APPLIED

Version History

Version	Date	Description
3.0	May 2026	Initial Step-Back/Earn-Back framework
3.1	May 2026	Added Clerical Error Safe Harbor and modular liquidity brake
3.2	May 2026	Three-tier breach system compressed; evidentiary standards added
4.0	May 2026	Integrated Core Triad governance, 30-Day Sprint option, Direct Co-Arbitration, No Goalpost Moving, expanded Judicial Pause, No US Custody clause, and Executive Summary page. Merged from GSA v1.5 and Mutual Step-Back Agreement v4.0.

This document constitutes the Framework for Reciprocal Stabilization Version 4.0

Authorized Negotiators Only — Distribution Restricted

Joint Coordination Secretariat — Geneva, Switzerland / Muscat, Oman — May 2026